

Global e-waste to grow at 4-5 per cent annually

The global quantity of electronics waste (e-waste) is expected to touch 49.8 million tonnes by 2018 from the current level of 47.8 million tonnes, growing annually at a rate of 4 to 5 per cent, according to an ASSO-CHAM-Sofies-Toxics Link joint study.

The top three Asian countries with the highest e-waste generation

in absolute quantities are China (6.0 million tonnes), Japan (2.2 million tonnes) and India (1.7 million tonnes). In India, approximately 1.5 per cent of the total e-waste generated is recycled by formal recyclers or institutional processing and recycling, while another 8 per cent goes to landfills.

Wearable devices becoming popular

Gartner, Inc. forecasts that 310.4 million wearable devices will be sold worldwide in 2017—an increase of 16.7 per cent from 2016. Of the \$30.5-billion sales revenue generated by wearable devices, \$9.3 billion will be from smartwatches. In all, 41.5 million smartwatches will be sold

this year. By 2021, the number will increase to nearly 81 million units, representing 16 per cent of total wearable device sales.

Bluetooth headsets will account for 48 per cent of all wearable devices in 2017, with sales of 150 million units. Bluetooth sales will increase to 206 million units in 2021, meaning

Awards

Super Plastronics wins India's best electronics licensee award

TV sets and other electronics manufacturer Super Plastronics, a Kodak brand licensee, has won 'India's Best Licensee Award' at India Licensing Expo held recently in Delhi. Super Plastronics is one of India's foremost original equipment manufacturers of CRT and LED TVs. It has three manufacturing plants in India located in Noida, Una and Jammu.

ELCINA-EFY Awards

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India gains momentum in biometric transactions

According to the Voice of Asia report by Deloitte, India is one of the leading digital transaction players. It says that the government has managed to save ₹ 361.44 billion over the last two years by directly

transferring benefits via the Aadhaar Payment Bridge. In February this year, Gujarat became the first state in India to set up a cashless system in its foodgrain public distribution system. Aadhaar-enabled payment system was

installed in approximately 17,250 fair price shops. So people eligible for subsidised food grains under the National Food Security Act (NFSA) need to present only their Aadhaar numbers to collect the allotted rations.

Dell Foundation plans an incubator

The Michael and Susan Dell Foundation is looking to set up an incubator for startups with solutions for the underserved and the unserved segments. The foundation is in talks with IIM-Ahmedabad's

Centre for Innovation Incubation and Entrepreneurship (CIIE) for the same.

The incubator will look at early-stage companies that offer financial inclusion, digital empowerment, job creation and services in other such

impact areas, according to Rahil Rangwala, the director for family economic stability at Michael and Susan Dell Foundation. The foundation will also offer seed funding to the startups.

C-DOT launches latest innovation WiDHWAN

Centre for Development of Telematics (C-DOT), India's premier telecom R&D organisation, has added another

feather to its cap with the launch of WiDHWAN, which has been exclusively designed to cater to the

recurring call drop issues in no-signal and low-signal network scenarios in places such as offices and homes.